

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1035

By Salinas

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory and celebrate the life of
John Wilkins Haley of Memphis.

WHEREAS, it was with great sadness that the members of this General Assembly learned of the untimely passing of John Wilkins Haley, who will be fondly remembered for his sense of humor, artistic talent, humility, and compassion in action; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Haley was a world traveler who, through his diverse experiences in early life, developed the courage to launch out into the world in service to others; and

WHEREAS, he had visited Holland, Germany, Spain, Mexico, South Sudan, Colombia, England, and many more nations, and his fascination with other cultures and genuine interest in people enabled him to connect easily wherever he went; and

WHEREAS, although he was a native of Memphis, John Haley lived in Hermosa Beach, California, as a child before his family relocated to New Hampshire, where they resided in a herdsman's trailer on a dairy farm for a time; and

WHEREAS, returning with his family to Memphis at the age of six, John Haley graduated from White Station High School, attended Memphis College of Art, and earned a degree in photography from Southern Illinois University; and

WHEREAS, after graduating from college, he worked as a photographer for *The Memphis Flyer* and *Memphis Magazine*; he was also the photographer for Project Motion dance collective, and this work ignited his passion for unexpected dramatic shots, often intentionally taken out of focus; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Haley continued his interest in out-of-focus work with a series of flower close ups taken with a simple Diana camera, his favorite work; and

WHEREAS, while working as a photographer with the International Children's Heart Foundation, John Haley traveled to war zones worldwide, documenting both the critical surgeries and the living conditions of young patients and their families, often while experiencing bombing and other war maneuvers; and

WHEREAS, while living in a FEMA trailer after Hurricane Katrina, John Haley worked on community reconstruction in St. Bernard Parish, New Orleans, wisely reusing scrapped materials for property restoration, a practice he would utilize again when rehabbing homes in Memphis; and

WHEREAS, in 2005, Mr. Haley moved to Ireland, where he earned a master's degree in peace and development studies from the University of Limerick; one of his projects there involved election monitoring in Jerusalem during the 2006 legislative elections; and

WHEREAS, his work with non-governmental organizations next led him to Uganda, where he met his future wife, Grace, winning her heart on their first date with a gesture that captured the humility and generosity that defined him; and

WHEREAS, for five years, John Haley volunteered with the Butakoola Village Association in Uganda's Kayunga District, working to secure reliable access to clean drinking water for a community long affected by illnesses caused by contamination; and

WHEREAS, he eventually identified an innovative building method using recycled plastic bottles and mud, a demonstration of which led to the construction of a school bathroom and a well that supplied safe, sanitary water to the community; word of this success spread across Uganda and beyond, inspiring other communities throughout Africa; and

WHEREAS, in 2013, Mr. Haley returned to Memphis and was joined by Grace soon thereafter; they would later marry and settle into the Binghampton community, where he applied the techniques he learned in New Orleans to rehab affordable housing by using salvaged

materials enhanced with bold color, thereby preserving each house's original design and character; and

WHEREAS, at the time of Mr. Haley's death, he and Mrs. Haley were building Green Dream Farm, an eco-retreat in Hoima, Uganda, which was named after the New Hampshire farm where he had lived as a child; and

WHEREAS, John Haley's influence lives on in each life he touched; in his close relationships with his nephews, he fostered a love of adventure, travel, and food; and

WHEREAS, John Wilkins Haley is survived by his wife, Grace Haley; his mother, Patricia Haley (John Cooper); his father, Stephen Haley (Diana Bell); his stepdaughter, Sheila Karungi; his brother, Jason Haley (Molly); his stepsister, Carole Cooper (Andrew) Moore and her sons, Cooper and Forrest; his mother-in-law, Loy Rujumba; his aunt, Anne Porterfield (Wink); his cousins, Lisa Bailey Evans (Jeff), Becky Van Wagoner (Christopher), and Lucas Wonert (Erica); his nephews, Cullen Haley (Maria Berrios), Ethan Haley, Nathaniel Haley, and Joel Hochman; and his niece, Sarah Hochman; and

WHEREAS, John Haley is mourned by a global community of friends and colleagues and a large and loving family, and we wish to pay our respects to a gentleman who lived "life to the lees" in devoted service to his fellow human beings; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we celebrate the life of John Wilkins Haley of Memphis, even as we honor his memory and mourn his passing, remembering the purposeful life of a humble man who accomplished much good in the world and was beloved by all who knew him.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that we extend our condolences to Mr. Haley's family and many friends.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.